CITY of BOSTON

Digital Team
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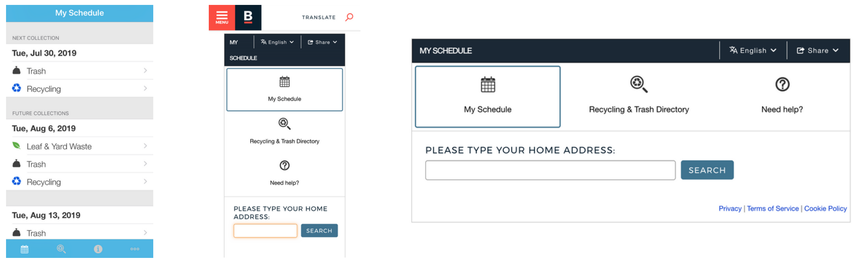
MY WORK

TRASH DAY APP

My main project this summer: ***City of Boston's Trash Day App****.*



The mobile app, the mobile web page, and the desktop web page of the Trash Day App

What does it do? *Boston residents can find their trash schedule, set reminders to take out the trash, and search Boston's waste directory to find out what they can/cannot recycle.*

Background: *The City had a lot of questions about the Trash Day App at the beginning of the summer:*

- *Has the app been performing well?*
- *How are people using the app?*
- *Are there any features of the app we aren't using?*
- ***What should we do with the app?***

Research: *I had to think creatively to get the information I needed. In addition to examining app* ***analytics****, I conducted 13* ***user testing*** *sessions and created a* ***survey*** *which received 265 responses.*

Findings: *My research concluded that the city* ***should*** *continue to maintain the Trash Day App. There is a significant amount of users on all its platforms and the features of the app line up nicely with users' needs.*

However, my research isn't perfect. It's meant to serve as a foundation for future research on the app. The City might not have a final decision for the app right now, but my research will help guide them in the right direction.

GENERAL ASSEMBLY PARTNERSHIP

I spearheaded a partnership with a group from ***General Assembly*** *that conducted research around the* ***usage of tables on boston.gov.***

In the course of three weeks, I learned a ton about product management. I was able to oversee the birth of the project, the hand-off of final deliverables, and everything in between.

The group made recommendations that included a table style guide that increased the site's ***System Usability Scale*** *from 75% to 81%.*

The General Assembly Team and the Digital Team

LOCATION	ADDRESS	FEATURES
Clarendon St Play Lot	260 Clarendon St.	Playground for ages 2-12, Swings, Stage/Ampitheater
Copley Square	560 Boylston St	Public Art, Stage/Ampitheater
Myrtle St Playground	50 Myrtle St	Playground & Play Structure for ages 5-12, Swings for Ages 2-12
Phillips St Play Area	50 Myrtle St	Playground & Play Structure for Ages 5-12, Theater/Ampitheater
Public Garden	4 Charles St	Public Art

The finalized table style guide

AND OTHER THINGS

I also volunteered to take on a variety of smaller projects:

- *Conducted quality assurance testing of the* ***"Boston Info" Alexa Skill*** *and the* ***migration of Boston.gov*** *from Drupal 7 to 8.*
- *Streamlined the process of handling email bounces within* ***Postmark****, an email delivery service, that hosts boston.gov's contact forms and receipts from Boston's registry.*
  Now, the city has an easy way to monitor bounced emails that would've gone unattended.
- *Assisted the Digital Team send out a* ***Request for Proposal for a User Experience partnership****. My support helped the City receive 9 proposals from a variety of local and national firms.*

MISSION

Ensure accessible experiences for Boston residents and visitors that are:

- *Equal parts warm and official*
- *Designed around their needs*
- *Delightful and highly useful*

WHAT WE DO

The Digital Team works on digital initiatives and tools with departments across the City.

Our small group of design, engineering, and content specialists keep the City focused on end users and their needs.

More of their work can be found on:
boston.gov/roadmap
github.com/CityofBoston/digital

TAKEAWAYS

User Experience (UX)
UX is something I never really paid much attention to before this summer, yet it's something that we all encounter in our everyday lives.

Accessibility and Equity
Thinking about the City of Boston's 'user base' is incredibly tricky because we are doing things for ***every single person in Boston.***

Working in a Municipality
It's easy to think of a city as a compact, singular entity. When in reality, it's all these different ***departments*** *and* ***people*** *that come together to make things happen.*